THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 25: **The Trees (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** Adrienne Rich	An American poet.
2	**(d)** return to nature and freedom	Freedom.
3	**(c)** free verse	No strict rhyme.
4	**(c)** moving out into the forest	They are trying to leave.
5	**(c)** quiet and yearning	Subtle.
6	**(c)** tense and hopeful	Expectant.
7	**(d)** empty	Empty of trees till now.
8	**(a)** both attachment to and distance from the trees	Mixed.
9	**(a)** the top branches	Top.
10	**(c)** freedom	To be free.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	They are moving out into the forest (1) as if tired of confinement (1).	1+1
12	She is sitting in the room writing (1) while the trees try to leave (1).	1+1
13	Quiet and yearning (1) with growing tension (1).	1+1
14	It was empty (1) with only the wind where trees should be (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A room with potted trees (1). A forest outside (1). The trees stir to leave (1).	1+1+1
16	Trees as captive beings (1). Forest as freedom (1). Room as restriction (1).	1+1+1
17	Expectant (1). Yearning (1). Slightly uneasy (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They move and strive (1). They have desires (1). They seem like people breaking free (1).	1+1+1
18	Women were confined indoors (1). The trees represent their desire to escape (1). The poem suggests liberation (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The poet said that the trees were leaving (1). Tense changes (1). The statement is preserved (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Trees want to leave (1). Forest is home (1). Poet watches (1). Freedom theme (1). Symbolism (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address (1). Greeting (1). Explanation (1). Opinion (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Trees move out (1). Forest empty (1). Roots tear (1). Moon in oak (1). Poet writes (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Both confined (1). Trees versus tiger (1). Tone (1). Symbol (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying the trees are outside the house moving in; the poem says the trees are **moving out** from the room toward the forest.
- Missing the personification: the trees **try to leave**, a symbol of freedom.
- Treating the poem as only about nature; it also suggests **freedom from confinement**, even women's longing for release.
- Mixing the poet: **Adrienne Rich**, who writes in free verse about nature and human liberty.
- Ignoring the images, such as the cold night and the moon 'broken like a mast'; write one image with its meaning.
- Spelling slips: *glass, forest, personification, free verse, inching*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 25: **The Trees (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** the trees are about to leave the room	Departure.
2	**(d)** the trees' act of leaving	Contrast.
3	**(b)** writing	She is writing.
4	**(a)** a room with a forest outside	Room and forest.
5	**(a)** The room is being left by the trees.	Present continuous passive.
6	**(b)** beings that long for freedom (including women)	Symbol.
7	**(c)** several stanzas	A longer poem.
8	**(a)** freedom	Confinement x freedom.
9	**(d)** nature and confinement	Theme.
10	**(a)** no bird could sit and no insect hide there	The poem says no bird could sit and no insect hide there.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Beings that long for freedom (1) such as nature or women (1).	1+1
12	They want to be in the forest (1) where they naturally belong (1).	1+1
13	Their roots tear free (1) and their branches push to get out (1).	1+1
14	The natural, free world (1) where the trees belong (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It lights the forest (1). It is like a broken mirror (1). It adds a magical mood (1).	1+1+1
16	Roots tearing (1). Branches pushing (1). Leaves reaching (1).	1+1+1
17	The tiger hated confinement (1). She felt a yearning for freedom (1). Both words are used correctly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: To show the trees' home is waiting (1). To stress the lack of life (1). To justify their departure (1).	1+1+1
18	It makes the strain subtle (1). It builds quiet tension (1). It suits a thoughtful theme (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Respect nature's freedom (1). Value liberty (1). Do not confine living things (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Trees as captive (1). Room as confinement (1). Forest as freedom (1). Poet as observer (1). Meaning (1).	2+2+1
	OR: First person (1). Confinement (1). Desire (1). Escape (1). Hope (1).	2+2+1
20	Theme (1). Imagery (1). Tone (1). Symbol (1). Opinion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). Room (1). Trees (1). Feelings (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

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- Treating the poem as only about nature; it also suggests **freedom from confinement**, even women's longing for release.
- Mixing the poet: **Adrienne Rich**, who writes in free verse about nature and human liberty.
- Ignoring the images, such as the cold night and the moon 'broken like a mast'; write one image with its meaning.
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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 25: **The Trees (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** longing	Strong desire.
2	**(a)** mirror	A broken mirror.
3	**(b)** painful and determined	Struggle.
4	**(c)** into	Into the forest.
5	**(d)** tallest oak	In the crown of the oak.
6	**(b)** reaching toward the outside	Longing.
7	**(b)** freedom of nature and people	Message.
8	**(a)** tearing free from the floor	They pull out.
9	**(a)** pressing against the glass	Straining.
10	**(a)** it speaks of the desire to be free	Relevance.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Adrienne Rich (1) an American poet (1).	1+1
12	As a broken mirror (1) glittering in the oak's crown (1).	1+1
13	The urge to be free from confinement (1) and return to one's natural home (1).	1+1
14	It shows the departure is imminent (1) leaving the room empty (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She sits writing (1). She watches the trees (1). She is both near and apart (1).	1+1+1
16	Nature is alive (1). It resists captivity (1). It deserves freedom (1).	1+1+1
17	It shows trees as living (1). It encourages protecting forests (1). It warns against keeping nature indoors only (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is painful (1). It cannot hold living things for long (1). Freedom is natural (1).	1+1+1
18	A fractured world (1). Distorted reflection (1). A turning point (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Symbols are not explained (1). It deals with freedom (1). Readers bring their own views (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Intro (1). Trees' role (1). Poem (1). Threats (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Roots (1). Branches (1). Leaves (1). Moon (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
20	Greeting (1). Poem (1). Examples (1). Appeal (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Tree's wish (1). Poet's reply (1). Conflict (1). End (1).	2+2+1

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